

Question:

A 6 year old girl is easily distracted in class and exhibits poor scholastic performance. Seizures are precipitated by hyperventilation. What is the probable diagnosis?

Answer Choices:

- A. Myoclonic seizures
- B. Absence seizures
- C. Atonic seizures
- D. Myoclonia

Reasoning + Answer:

<thought>

To solve this problem , I need to consider the symptoms given : a 6-year-old girl is easily distracted , exhibits poor scholastic performance , and seizures are triggered by hyperventilation .

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<answer>

B . absence seizures </answer>

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Myoclonic seizures (A) involve sudden , brief jerks , and atonic seizures (C) result in a loss of muscle tone , which are less likely to cause poor scholastic performance .

Since the seizures are triggered by hyperventilation , absence seizures (B) are the most plausible diagnosis . Absence seizures , also known as petit mal seizures , affect children and can cause periods of staring , rapid blinking , or running about with little to no memory of what happened after the seizure ends . This fits the described symptoms well : distractibility , poor academic performance , and hyperventilation-induced seizures .

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